HACKYEAH 2026 · SUPERTEAM POLAND

Bestcrow

Escrow that releases by rule, not by an operator. Startup/prototype crowdfunding on Solana where backers approve each release and every failure path is permissionless.

Anchor program · **Backer-weighted votes** · **Pro-rata refunds**

PROBLEM · WHO IT HURTS

Two people who don't know each other, and a platform both must trust

The creator

Needs capital before the work exists. Today that means a platform decides if the campaign qualifies, and holds every pledge until it pays out.

The backer

Hands money to a stranger and to the platform. If the target is met, the creator usually gets the whole balance — with no further accountability.

Named users: **early-stage startup / prototype teams** raising in milestones, and their backers. Reward/grant funding — not equity.

The operator profits twice: an **upfront platform cut** (typically a few percent of the raise plus payment processing) and **control** — it can freeze or reject a campaign and decides when the creator is paid.

THE INTERMEDIARY, NAMED · DESIGN RATIONALE

The operator is custody plus discretionary payout

Before (Kickstarter-style)

Custodies all pledges · charges a cut · can freeze or reject · on success pays the creator everything at once.

After (Bestcrow)

Funds sit in a program-owned vault · schedule + recipients fixed at creation · releases gated by backer votes · failure refunds pro-rata.

Why not a database? A DB admin can edit state and still controls the payout rails. Here the rule — not an operator — is the source of truth, and neither party can bypass it.

HOW IT WORKS · PART 1

Terms are locked before the first pledge

Create draft → **Add 2–5 tranches (≤50% each, =100%)** → **Seal & open funding**

- Funding window **7–183 days**; overfunding allowed — no cap at the goal.
- Each tranche's share, work period and recipients are fixed; no post-start edits.
- A creator **bond** is posted separately from backer funds.

HOW IT WORKS · PART 2

Backers approve each release — the rule decides

Evidence → 7-day vote

Weight = final pledge. Approval needs **>50%** of all contributions. Exactly 50% or no votes = no.

One revision, then stop

First failure opens **30 days** to improve, then a second 7-day vote. Second failure → termination.

An approved tranche is payable **exactly once** to a fixed recipient. Anyone may trigger the technical release once the rule is satisfied.

HOW IT WORKS · FAILURE IS FIRST-CLASS

Every failure path is permissionless and pro-rata

- **Missed goal:** no fee; each backer claims 100% of their own pledge.
- **Termination:** the remaining pool is frozen and refunded proportionally to frozen pledge weight.
- **Double-claim guard:** refunds/releases are exactly-once; a closed ledger can't be replayed.
- **Anyone can submit** an eligible finalize/refund transaction — a timer never moves money by itself.

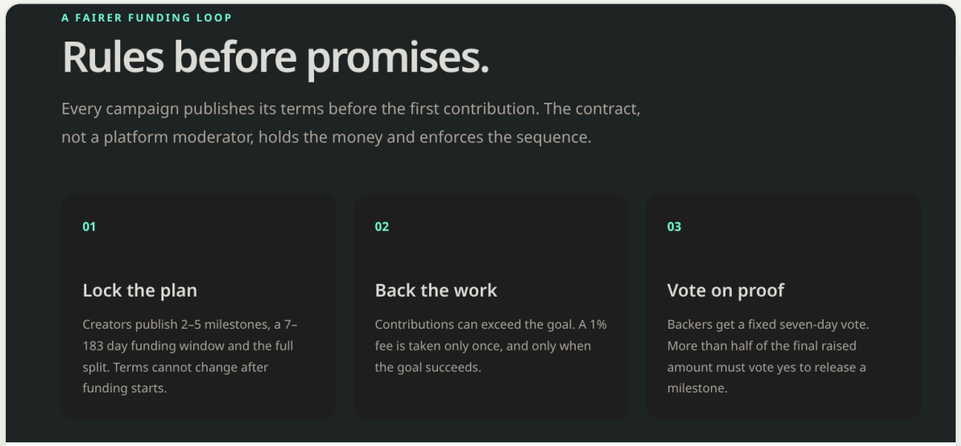
If a party disappears: the goal simply misses and refunds open; a rejected milestone terminates and refunds; approved tranches stay claimable. **No single party can lock the money.**

PROOF, NOT A MOCKUP · THE APPLICATION

Click-through flow — rules, funding, wallet, profile



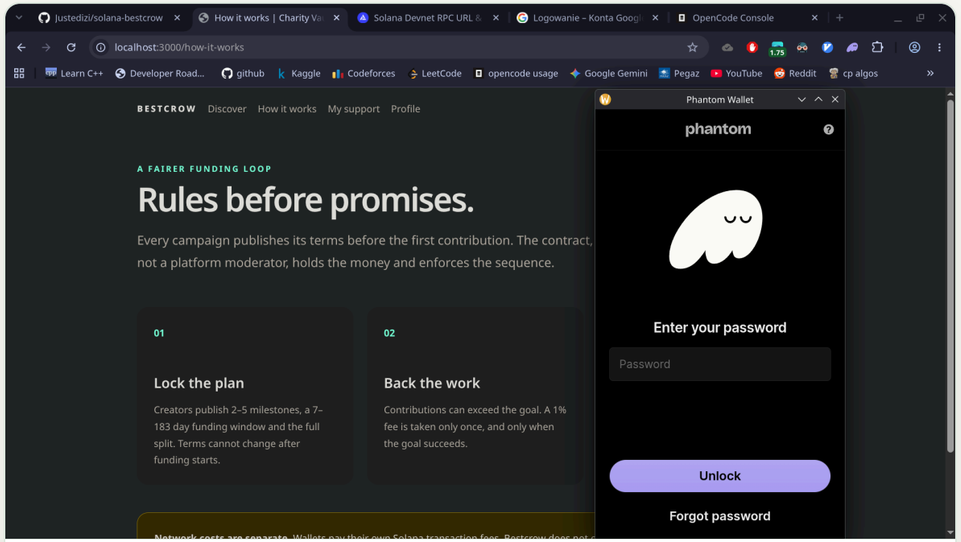
Landing: the pitch and the fixed protocol parameters (2–5 milestones · 7-day vote · 1% success fee · 0 SOL creator deposit).



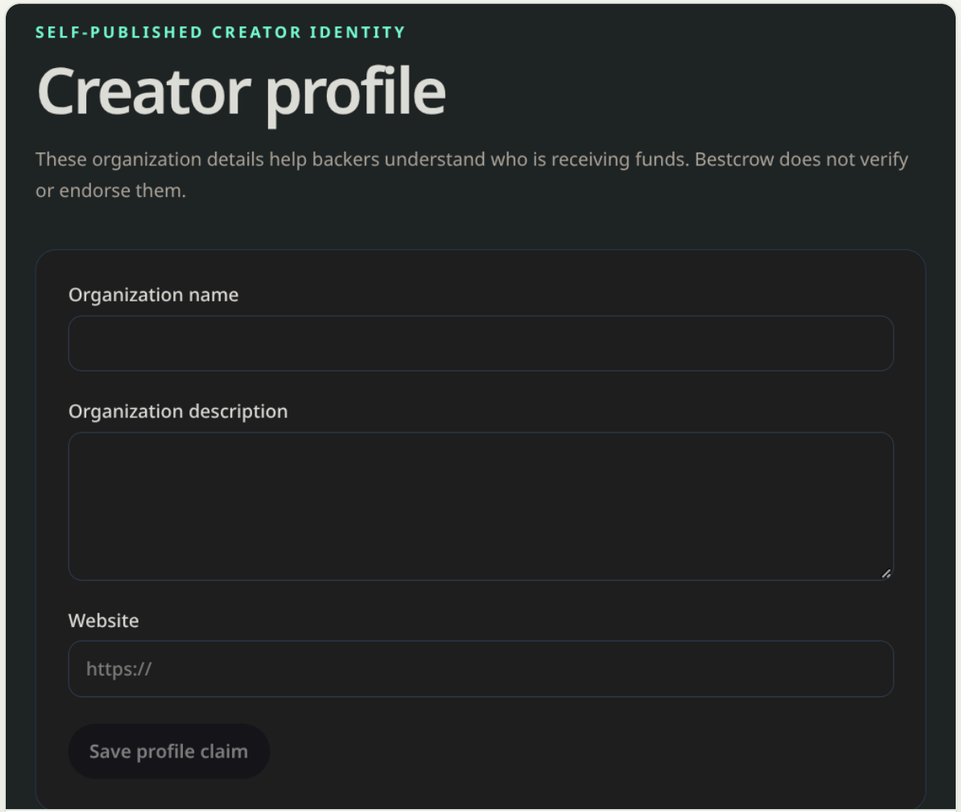
“Rules before promises”: what each backer sees before contributing.

PROOF · LIVE FLOW AND ON-CHAIN EVIDENCE

Runs live — and every step is a transaction you can inspect



Funding flow with a connected wallet.



Creator profile — self-published, not platform-verified.

On-chain proof (open in Solana Explorer):

Bestcrow MVP `3jGgPRa4gH25wfL49E3TAtpix5ePUZKWrQLT83eNZBVr` — explorer.solana.com/address/…?cluster=devnet

Base escrow `74GsU9xRv9qvVHXXvTAAmRp8ETTEAwGjV1UkJQ6BZNpG` — explorer.solana.com/address/…?cluster=devnet

WHAT IS TRUE TODAY

What the program does — and the one honest limit

Enforced on-chain

Fixed goal, deadline and recipients · program-owned vault · permissionless finalization and refunds · exactly-once releases · disclosed upgrade authority.

The honest limit

The program enforces **money**, not worthiness or delivery. Backer votes express approval, not product quality. Previously paid funds can't be clawed back. Upgrade authority is disclosed, not hidden.

WHY THIS WINS · WHAT'S NEXT

Rule-enforced custody — and a roadmap that keeps the trust honest

Why it maps to the brief

Relevance: the operator's custody and payout power are removed on-chain. **Completeness:** a full click-through flow on live programs. **Idea:** a named user and an honest trust boundary. **Implementation:** Anchor + tests + client. **Originality:** a tokenless conditional vault — no oracle to manipulate.

Next

Wire the staged vote/release into the MVP program, run the adversarial test matrix, redeploy, add a durable terms/evidence store, then pilot with a real prototype team.